

HOUSE No. 1373

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Steven S. Howitt

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to establishing a health safety net task force.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Steven S. Howitt</i>	<i>4th Bristol</i>	<i>1/14/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 1373

By Representative Howitt of Seekonk, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 1373) of Steven S. Howitt for legislation to establish a health safety net task force (including members of the General Court) to study reimbursement for dental care and healthcare provided by hospitals and accredited teaching institutions to MassHealth members. Health Care Financing.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 1204 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to establishing a health safety net task force.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Section 66 of Chapter 118E of the Massachusetts General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is here by amended by inserting in place the following new section:

3 “Section XX. Notwithstanding any general or special law to the contrary, there shall be a
4 special task force to review and report on the Health Safety Net and the financial impact of the
5 reimbursement for basic and restorative dental care and general healthcare provided by
6 Massachusetts hospitals and accredited teaching institutions, including dental schools, to
7 MassHealth members. The task force shall consist of 14 members: the house and senate chairs of
8 the joint committees on health care financing or their designees, who shall serve as the co-chairs
9 of the task force; a member of the general court appointed by the senate minority leader; a

10 member of the general court appointed by the house minority leader; the Commissioner of the
11 Massachusetts Department of Public Health, or a designee; the president of the Massachusetts
12 Health and Hospital Association, the deans of Boston University School of Medicine and Boston
13 University Dental School; the deans of Tufts Medical School and Tufts Dental School; the deans
14 of Harvard Medical School and Harvard Dental School and 2 persons to be appointed by the
15 secretary of the Executive Office of Health and Human Services.

16 This task force shall: (i) identify and review all current state laws, regulations, and
17 administrative directives that relate to health care reimbursement; (ii) identify financial and
18 procedural steps that would best allow payment to Boston's teaching facilities through
19 MassHealth; (iii) submit recommendations to establish legislative procedures that provide
20 funding, regulate, and grant reimbursement power to MassHealth for care from accredited
21 Massachusetts hospitals and teaching facilities.

22 The task force shall submit a report, including any draft legislation and regulations, to the
23 clerks of the house and representatives and the senate within 12 months of the passage of this act.